FOR PARENTS AND TEACHERS

Unit 7: Retroflex and z

ڈ ڑ ز ژ

1 In this unit



Hard ڈ vs soft ڑ; د the flapped r that never starts a word; ز; the rare Persian ژ.

How long: About 2.5 hours for a child, 1 for an adult. Do 10 minutes a day, short and happy.

ڈ ڑ ز ژ

2 What to say and show, letter by letter

	Say	How the pen moves	Often mixed up with
ڈ	**ḍāl** ڈال hard English 'd' in dad, tongue curled back	top down and out to the left in one angled stroke, then the small ط sign on top, last	dāl
ڑ	**ṛe** ڑے a flapped 'r'/'d' made with the tongue curled back (no English match)	top down and sweep left below the line, then the small ط sign on top, last	re, ze
ز	**ze** زے 'z' in zoo	top down and sweep left below the line; the dot last	re, ṛe, zhe
ژ	**zhe** ژے 's' in pleasure (Persian loanwords only, rare)	top down and sweep left below the line; the dots last	ze, re

3 How to use the sheets

1. **Trace and write**: one page per letter. Start at the dot, follow the arrow; body first, dots last.
2. **Look-alikes**: circle the same letter, then sort by dots.
3. **Join the letters**: standing letters into a joined word.
4. **Read and match**: word to meaning.
5. **Reading practice**: words, sentences, story.
6. **Dictation**: the grown-up says it, the child writes it.
7. **Unit check**: 10 questions. The answer key is the last page of the unit-check PDF; in the unit pack the keys are on the last pages.

4 How to check

- **Letters:** cover the sound, point to the letter, the child says it. 3 of 4 right is a pass.
- **Writing:** look at the start dot and the direction, not at how pretty it is. Right to left, body first, dots last.
- **Unit check:** 8 of 10 means go on. Under 8: redo the look-alike and trace sheets, try again tomorrow.
- **Praise** effort: “you started on the right”, “good dots”. One sheet a day beats five at once.

5 A 10-minute sitting

2 min warm-up: point to last time’s letters, the child says them. **5 min** the sheet of the day: say it, trace it, write it. **3 min** read it back together and end on something done well.